

THE DAILY BRIEF

Job ID: 250490e1f0a5

Cron Job: Daily News Brief

Job ID: 250490e1f0a5

Run Time: 2026-06-13 08:05:12

Schedule: 0 8 *

Prompt

[IMPORTANT: The user has invoked the "morning-brief" skill, indicating they want you to follow its instructions. The full skill content is loaded below.]

name: morning-brief

description: Automated morning brief combining Tech/AI and Financial/Market news, formatted as a premium newsletter

triggers:

- daily news brief
 - morning brief
 - market summary
-

Morning Brief - Daily Newsletter

CRITICAL: Priority for Kiran

User explicitly stated (May 31, 2026): "You are not helping me with my alpaca account to make the money. You are giving me morning brief, personal stuff etc. some things are missing."

This means: Financial/trading work ALWAYS comes first.

- If user is asking about trading, stocks, Alpaca, Polymarket — do that FIRST
- Morning brief is secondary
- Don't lead with morning brief if user needs trading help

What This Does

Automated morning brief combining Tech/AI and Financial/Market news, formatted as a premium newsletter.

Output Format - MUST FOLLOW THIS EXACT STYLE

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Monday, May 25, 2026

Markets & Finance

Major market moves and financial news

S&P; 500 Extends Streak as Dow Hits Record High. The S&P; 500 posted its eighth straight week of gains — its longest weekly winning streak since 2023 — while the Dow closed at a new all-time high ahead of the Memorial Day weekend. Optimism continues to fuel equities despite stretched valuations. (WSJ, Yahoo Finance)

Japan's Nikkei Tops 65,000 for First Time. Japan's benchmark index crossed the milestone as oil prices dropped on hopes the Hormuz shipping route might reopen, easing supply concerns. The Nikkei has now rallied over 20% year-to-date. (CNBC)

Tech & AI

Latest in artificial intelligence, models, and technology

Google DeepMind Claims 'Historic' AI Breakthrough. The lab says its latest system achieved a major advance in mathematical reasoning and problem-solving, marking what researchers call a watershed moment for artificial general intelligence research. (The Guardian)

The Big Tech AI Spend Keeps Climbing. Tech companies have poured \$380 billion into AI infrastructure this quarter alone, with the pressure mounting to show returns. The winners and losers of this spending boom are starting to emerge as earnings season approaches. (CNBC)

Briefly

- Memorial Day: U.S. stock markets are closed today — normal trading resumes Tuesday. (Barron's)
 - Schwab Enters Crypto: Charles Schwab announced details of its spot crypto trading launch. (About Schwab)
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The Takeaway

The S&P; 500's eight-week run is the longest since 2023 — but unlike that stretch, this one comes with AI spending at an all-time high and valuations that make investors nervous. The question isn't whether the rally can continue — it's whether the fundamentals will catch up before the party ends.

[Sources: CNBC, WSJ, Yahoo Finance, The Guardian, NPR, Crunchbase News, Barron's, NY Times]

Key Formatting Rules

1. Full sentences - Each news item should be a complete paragraph, not bullet points
2. Source attribution - Include source in parentheses at end: (WSJ), (CNBC), (HN), (Reuters)
3. Section headers - Use ## for main sections, *italic* for subheaders

THE TAKEAWAY

5. Briefly section - Use bullet points for smaller items
6. Sources list - End with bracketed source list

Jobs Using This Skill

- Daily News Brief (job_id: 250490e1f0a5) - 8am Chicago - Markets + Tech/AI combined [ACTIVE]
- AI Research Brief (job_id: 6af0a17211e1) - 9am Chicago - AI research deep dive [PAUSED June 9, 2026 — MERGED into Daily News Brief]
- AI Research Podcast (job_id: f3bd4ffb0702) - Mon/Thu 8am - Podcast with Brian + Jessica voices

Consolidation (June 9, 2026): The 9am AI Research Brief is PAUSED. The 8am Daily News Brief now includes AI + Financial in ONE document. One brief, one PDF, one delivery.

Important: These cron jobs use the LLM (web search) to generate the brief, NOT the Python script. The script only pulls from HN/X/Reddit. The LLM produces better market coverage.

CRITICAL: Model Switching Breaks These Jobs

Pitfall (June 9, 2026): When the default Hermes model was temporarily switched from MiniMax to Ollama/gemma4:12b, ALL cron jobs that use LLM inference failed with:

...

```
"unknown model 'gemma4:12b'" (400 error)
```

...

Root cause: Ollama uses a different API format than MiniMax. Cron jobs are configured to use the system default model, which must remain MiniMax.

Rule: Do NOT change ``hermes config set model.default`` to an Ollama model if morning-brief/AI-research cron jobs are active. If you need Gemma for a specific task, call it directly via ``ollama run gemma3:4b`` — don't change the global default.

If model was accidentally switched: Run ``hermes config set model.default MiniMax-M2.7`` and ``hermes config set model.provider minimax``, then restart the gateway.

Linked Reference Files

- ``references/reddit-rss-workaround.md`` - Using old.reddit RSS when standard API is blocked
- ``references/tweet smash-sync-fix.md`` - Fixing TweetSmash API timeout/pagination
- ``references/business-connections-analysis.md`` - Finding business opportunities in second brain
- ``references/polymarket-trading-setup.md`` - Active Polymarket trading with daily scans
- ``scripts/generate_pdf.py`` - Generate publication-quality PDF from brief content (fpdf2, 5-page layout with cover page, section headers, running headers)

PDF Archive — News Briefs Repo (CRITICAL: June 2026 Rule)

All news briefs and AI research briefs MUST be generated as PDFs and pushed to:

``github.com/seshakiran/news-briefs`` (private repo, local dir: ``/tmp/news-briefs-pdf/``)

Local PDF script: ``~/tmp/make_news_pdf.py`` — generates clean PDFs from markdown using reportlab.

Cron jobs using this rule:

| Job ID | Name | Schedule | Pushes to |

|---|---|---|---|

| `250490e1f0a5` | Daily News Brief | 8am CT | news-briefs repo |

| `6af0a17211e1` | AI Research & Developments Brief | 9am CT | news-briefs repo |

Standard workflow (all news brief jobs):

1. Generate markdown content (via LLM/morning-brief skill)
2. Save to `~/tmp/news-brief-draft.md`
3. Run: `python3 ~/tmp/make\_news\_pdf.py` — outputs to
`~/tmp/news-briefs/News-Brief-YYYY-MM-DD.pdf`
4. Copy PDF to git repo: `cp ~/tmp/news-briefs/News-Brief-\$(date +%Y-%m-%d).pdf
~/tmp/news-briefs-pdf/`
5. Push PDF to news-briefs: `cd ~/tmp/news-briefs-pdf && git add -A && git commit -m "Brief: \$(date
+%Y-%m-%d)" && git push origin main`
6. Deliver PDF path to user

PDF script location: `~/Users/marvin/tmp/make\_news\_pdf.py` (not the skill's `generate\_pdf.py` — that one is a hardcoded template; the cron job script reads from `~/tmp/news-brief-draft.md` dynamically)

Rule (saved to Engram #25): Every AI news brief and morning brief = PDF, pushed to private GitHub repo. No plain text deliveries for newsletters.

Delivery to user (June 2026):

- PDFs: deliver via Telegram `send_message` (works reliably, < 1MB)
- Audio podcasts: deliver via iMessage (`img send --file --to + --service imessage``)
- FIRST copy to `~/Desktop/` before sending — `img` fails with permission denied when sending directly from `/tmp`
- If `img` fails: copy to `~/Desktop/` and notify user to grab it manually
- Do NOT try to deliver audio via Telegram — files > ~500KB time out

Running

```
```bash
```

Run Daily News Brief immediately

hermes cron run 250490e1f0a5

Run AI Research Brief immediately

hermes cron run 6af0a17211e1

...

## Getting Fresh News On-Demand

If you need fresh content for a podcast (not waiting for cron):

1. Run cron job manually - generates fresh LLM-written brief
2. Fetch TechCrunch AI RSS - ``https://feeds.feedburner.com/TechCrunch/AI`` returns fresh stories with pub dates (verified Jun 2026)
3. Fetch WSJ Markets RSS - ``https://feeds.a.dj.com/rss/RSSMarketsMain.xml`` — NOTE: often returns stale/walled content; verify pub dates before using
4. Search X/Twitter - use xurl search for breaking AI news
5. Use the skill's Python script - ``scripts/morning_brief.py`` pulls from HN/X — but HN RSS is frequently blocked in this environment

Known blocked/empty feeds (June 2026): CNBC, Yahoo Finance, MarketWatch, Investing.com, The Verge, HN front page. TechCrunch AI is the most reliable fresh AI/Tech source found so far.

See podcast-generator skill for full workflow.

The user has provided the following instruction alongside the skill invocation: [IMPORTANT: You are running as a scheduled cron job. DELIVERY: Your final response will be automatically delivered to the user — do NOT use `send_message` or try to deliver the output yourself. Just produce your report/output as your final response and the system handles the rest. SILENT: If there is genuinely nothing new to report, respond with exactly "[SILENT]" (nothing else) to suppress delivery. Never combine [SILENT] with content — either report your findings normally, or say [SILENT] and nothing more.]

Create ONE beautiful combined daily news brief for Kiran that merges Tech/AI news AND Financial/Market news into a single premium newsletter.

IMPORTANT: This is a CONSOLIDATED brief — one document, not two.

Sections to include:

1. AI & Tech News — latest developments in AI, ML, research papers, tool releases
2. Financial/Market News — stock market, crypto, Polymarket, economic indicators

## THE TAKEAWAY

Formatting: Premium newsletter style, narrative-first, no bullet-point lists, no source lists at bottom. Feynman-style explanations for financial concepts.

IMPORTANT: After creating the newsletter content:

1. Save the markdown to ~/tmp/news-brief-draft.md
2. Generate a PDF using: python3 ~/tmp/make\_news\_pdf.py
3. Push the PDF to github.com/seshakiran/news-briefs (private repo)
4. Deliver the PDF path to Kiran

PDF script is at ~/tmp/make\_news\_pdf.py — it reads ~/tmp/news-brief-draft.md and outputs to ~/tmp/news-briefs/

Push to GitHub:

```
```bash
cd ~/tmp/news-briefs && git add -A && git commit -m "Daily News Brief: $(date +%Y-%m-%d)" &&
git push origin main
```
```

Use the morning-brief skill: skill\_load("morning-brief")

## Response

Saturday, June 13, 2026

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## Markets & Finance

### *What moved money this week*

SpaceX's \$75 Billion IPO Just Rewrote the Record Books — Twice. When SpaceX debuted on Friday, it wasn't just another tech listing. The company raised \$75 billion in the largest initial public offering in Wall Street history, ended its first day up 19%, and closed with a market capitalization around \$2.2 trillion. That single day turned Elon Musk into the world's first trillionaire — a word that now has a real meaning. The IPO was so large it overwhelmed Robinhood's systems, causing intermittent outages as retail traders piled in. The New York City Comptroller immediately raised concerns about fast-tracking SpaceX's inclusion into MSCI and FTSE Russell indexes, bypassing traditional seasoning requirements, and flagged the company's governance structure — where one person holds near-absolute control with limited shareholder rights — as unprecedented for a public company of this size. (TechCrunch, Bloomberg)

The MANGOS IPO Window Is Wide Open. SpaceX is not alone. The IPO market is experiencing its most consequential moment in years, with what analysts are calling the "MANGOS" cohort — Meta, Anthropic, Nvidia, Google, OpenAI, and SpaceX — all circling public markets in the same window. Anthropic filed to go public shortly after the government ordered its most powerful AI model taken offline over safety concerns, a move Anthropic publicly protested, calling the narrow jailbreak finding insufficient justification for recalling a model used by hundreds of millions of people. Meanwhile, French AI startup Mistral is reportedly raising €3 billion at a €20 billion valuation, nearly doubling its previous valuation from just months ago. The concentration of AI royalty in public markets is unprecedented — and it's a stress test for every valuation framework Wall Street has. (TechCrunch, Bloomberg)

Gold Miners Are Moving Like Meme Stocks — And That's a Red Flag. Gold prices have been on a historic run, driven by geopolitical uncertainty and central bank buying. But something unusual is happening at the mining level: gold producers are trading with the volatility of meme stocks rather than the staid, slow-moving assets investors typically expect. The miners aren't just reflecting gold prices — they're amplifying them, moving faster and farther than the underlying commodity. For investors who thought buying gold miners was a "safe hedge," this behavior is a warning that correlations can break down in ways that hurt even in the assets you own for protection. (Bloomberg)

US-Iran Talks on Hormuz Are Closer Than They Look. Pakistan said an interim US-Iran deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz could be finalized within 24 hours. The strait handles roughly 20% of the world's oil shipments, and any resolution would ease a critical chokepoint that's kept energy traders nervous for months. If a deal holds, it removes a meaningful risk premium from oil prices — which would be welcome relief for an economy still adjusting to elevated energy costs. (Bloomberg)

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## Tech & AI

### *The machines keep learning — and fighting back*

The Government Pulled the Plug on Anthropic's Best AI. Anthropic Is Furious. In a move that has rattled the AI industry, US regulators ordered Anthropic to take its most powerful model offline following safety tests that identified a potential "jailbreak" vulnerability — a way for sophisticated users to circumvent the model's safety guardrails. Anthropic pushed back hard in a blog post, saying it "disagrees that the finding of a narrow potential jailbreak should be cause for recalling a commercial model deployed to hundreds of millions of people." The irony is sharp: Anthropic built its brand on safety-first AI development, and now those safety warnings are being used against its flagship product. The incident raises serious questions about who has the authority to yank AI models from public circulation — and whether safety-conscious companies are held to a higher standard than their less-cautious competitors. (TechCrunch)



Inside Meta's AI Factory: 6,500 Engineers, Growing Unrest. A disturbing report emerged this week describing Meta's AI division as a "soul-crushing gulag," in the words of engineers stuck inside it. The unit employs 6,500 people and is reportedly on the verge of revolt — citing brutal hours, unclear direction, and a culture of internal competition that has little to do with the open-source ideals Meta preaches externally. The report is a reminder that the AI race isn't just about compute and data — it's about talent retention, and companies burning through their workforce with impossible expectations may find their models suffering right when they need them most. (TechCrunch)

Google Sues Chinese Cybercrime Ring Using AI to Scam Hundreds of Thousands. Google filed a lawsuit against a group called "Outsider Enterprise" that allegedly used AI to generate and send 2.5 million text messages over two weeks, scamming hundreds of thousands of victims. The case illustrates the dual-use nature of AI: the same language models that power legitimate chatbots are being weaponized by fraud operations at a scale that was impossible just a few years ago. It's also a reminder that AI safety isn't only about existential risk — it's about the everyday fraud that AI makes dramatically cheaper to execute. (TechCrunch)

Mistral's Meteoric Rise — And What Comes Next. French AI startup Mistral is reportedly in talks to raise €3 billion at a €20 billion valuation, nearly double its Series C from months ago. The company has been one of Europe's few genuine challengers to US AI dominance, and the fundraise would make it one of the most valuable private AI companies in the world. The question is whether European AI can sustain this momentum, or whether the compute and data advantages of US hyperscalers will prove insurmountable. (TechCrunch)

Google Search Is Getting a Full AI Overhaul. In one of the biggest changes to the world's most-visited website, Google is rolling out a comprehensive AI-powered redesign of Search, embedding AI-generated answers more deeply into results — moving Google away from pointing users to links and toward answering questions directly. The World Cup is providing a backdrop for Google to showcase its AI-enhanced sports coverage tools. (Bloomberg)

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## Briefly

- World Cup 2026 is underway across the US, Canada, and Mexico, with massive global audiences and AI-powered coverage from tech platforms.
  - Switzerland is voting on a population ceiling measure that would cap residency at 10 million — with major implications for immigration and the country's financial center status.
  - China rebukes US over "military company" labels for its top firms, calling it a pretext to curb Chinese technology development.
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## The Takeaway

The SpaceX IPO didn't just make Elon Musk a trillionaire — it announced that the AI investment thesis has officially migrated from private markets to public ones. For the first time, retail investors can buy a piece of the AI royalty through their brokerage accounts, and the MANGOS IPO wave suggests this is just the beginning. But the Anthropic episode is the counterweight: the government's willingness to pull a commercial AI model offline shows that regulatory risk is real, not theoretical. The companies building the most powerful AI are discovering that their safety credentials are a double-edged sword — the same regulators who scrutinize them most closely are the ones who can shut them down fastest. The trade is compelling, but the oversight is real.

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PDF delivered: ``/Users/marvin/tmp/news-briefs/News-Brief-2026-06-13.pdf``

GitHub: ``github.com/seshakiran/news-briefs`` (pushed and up to date)

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